Acts 5:41

While revising the critical apparatus that goes with Acts, in my Greek Text, using the evidence as presented in the ECM Acts. I was brought to a stop by the variant set in Acts 5:41, that gives a nice demonstration that the transmission of the Text was not "controlled". For those who can handle Greek, here is that set, with the manuscript attestation.

κατηξιωθησαν υπερ του ονοματος – א,A,B,C + 9 MSS (NU)

κατηξιωθησαν υπερ του ονοματος αυτου – 17 MSS

κατηξιωθησαν υπερ του ονοματος του Χριστου – **f**^{35} + 6 MSS (WP)

κατηξιωθησαν υπερ του ονοματος του Ιησου – 13 MSS (CP)

κατηξιωθησαν υπερ του ονοματος Ιησου – 4 MSS

κατηξιωθησαν υπερ του ονοματος του Κυριου Ιησου – 2 MSS

κατηξιωθησαν υπερ του ονοματος του Θεου – 2 MSS

υπερ του ονοματος κατηξιωθησαν – D + 9 MSS

υπερ του ονοματος Ιησου κατηξιωθησαν – 16 MSS

υπερ του ονοματος αυτου κατηξιωθησαν – 13 MSS (OC,TR)

υπερ του ονοματος του Κυριου Ιησου κατηξιωθησαν – 12 MSS

υπερ του ονοματος του Ιησου κατηξιωθησαν – 8 MSS (HF,RP)

υπερ του ονοματος του Χριστου κατηξιωθησαν – 8 MSS

υπερ του ονοματος του Κυριου κατηξιωθησαν – 2 MSS

One is inclined to say that there is too much variation, although the different 'referents' are basically different ways of saying the same thing. For that matter, all fourteen variants have basically the same meaning. The numbers reflect the evidence as given in the ECM Acts and Swanson's Acts, to which I have added **f**^{35}. (Von Soden's treatment of this variant set is difficult to understand and can be misleading.) We have two basic sets of word order, with seven items each.

For the first set we have: **f**^{35},א,A,B,C + 53 MSS

For the second set we have: D + 68 MSS

Since **f**^{35} represents 15% of the total of all extant MSS (620 for Acts, including fragments), the first set is probably slightly ahead, but the evidence is evenly split. The choice between them will be guided by one's presuppositions. With either set the meaning is the same, which is typical of variation within the 'normal' transmission.

Setting aside **f**[35], we have 126 MSS; if we divide 126 by 600 (subtracting 20 as fragments), we get 21%, or roughly one fifth of the total. However, both ECM and Swanson chose mainly MSS that are more or less 'independent' of the Byzantine bulk (Swanson ignored **f**[35] altogether, and ECM included two MSS to represent it—there are 90 **f**[35] MSS in Acts). That said, and in this case, a collation of all extant MSS will probably yield a nearly even split between the two sets.

I will now present the evidence for the various 'referents' taken individually:

none = א,A,B,C,D + 18 MSS

αυτου = 30 MSS

του Χριστου = **f**[35] + 14 MSS

του Ιησου = 21 MSS

Ιησου = 20 MSS

του Κυριου Ιησου = 14 MSS

του Κυριου = 2 MSS

του Θεου = 2 MSS

Dear me, one could actually wish for a little more "control"! But as is typical of variation within the 'normal' transmission, there is scarcely any difference in the meaning. Nonetheless, for someone editing a Greek text, a choice must be made, and that choice will be guided by one's presuppositions, at least in part.